Christy Yu

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Education

Carnegie Mellon University 3.9 GPA | Aug. 2025 – Aug. 2026
Masters in Human Computer Interaction, School of Computer Science *Pittsburgh, PA*

UC Santa Barbara 3.75 GPA | Aug. 2021 – Jun. 2025
B.S. Computer Science, Statistical Science Minor *Santa Barbara, CA*

Experience

Design Engineer Intern Oct. 2026 - Present
Plasiv *San Jose, CA*

- Rebuilt the design system from Figma **tokens** to **44 coded components** in **2 weeks**, documented in Storybook, with a **DESIGN.md** guiding AI coding agents' UI changes
- Cut off-palette colors in new code from **23% to 14%** and off-scale font sizes from **15% to 9%**

Designer & Engineer Lead Jan. 2026 - Jul. 2026
Collier Township (Capstone) *Pittsburgh, PA*

- **Raised policy comprehension by 44%** among low tech-literacy residents of a **9k-resident** township, covering decisions, legal constraints, and budgets
- Built AI aid to retrieve and analyze civic data, **cutting time by 50%** for drafting new policies and grant proposals
- Validated product through 155 user tests, 30 qualitative interviews, 39 survey responses, and 6 in-person field visits

Product Design Intern Jan. 2026 - Sep. 2026
PLUS – Tutoring platform of 3k+ students, 500+ tutors *Pittsburgh, PA*

- Designed **3 student-tutor matching flows** with the PM and design lead, adding language compatibility and instant overrides to cut tutor supervisors' manual fixes

UI/UX Design Intern Jun. 2025 - Aug. 2025
Dawdle AI – Anti-procrastination app startup, featured in KCBS radio *San Francisco, CA*

- Designed **30+ screens** for the App Store launch (**200+ users, 5-star rating**), shaping AI coaching features with the CEO and engineers from beta feedback
- Built a **40+ component** design system in **Figma**, cutting design-to-dev iteration cycles by **25%**

Founding Designer & Frontend Engineer Oct. 2024 – Aug. 2025
JAFFX — open-source guitar pedal startup *Santa Barbara, CA*

- Secured **$7,500** funding, **2nd in 44 teams** at UCSB New Ventures Competition, pitch deck co-wrote with CEO
- Established full brand identity and design system from scratch (logo, typography, color)
- Developed responsive main website **(Next.js & React)** (live at jaffx.audio)

Software Engineer Intern Jun. 2024 – Aug. 2024
Lorentz Solution *Santa Clara, CA*

- Automated library clean-up and migrated **44 dynamic libraries** from **RHEL6** to **RHEL8** via **Bash** scripting, cutting backup and release package storage by **10%**

Data Analyst Research Fellowship Jan. 2023 – Aug. 2025
Human Wildlife Conflict emLab *Santa Barbara, CA*

- Built **habitat suitability ML models** in **R** for a **3rd-authored PNAS Nexus** paper on how climate change drives human-elephant conflict in Namibia

Projects

Refract | 2nd place research poster, annual showcase Jan. 2024 - May. 2024

∗ Built the **ML model** and designed and coded the frontend **(Figma, JavaScript, Tailwind)** for an app that shields personal photos from deepfakes with **engineered pixel changes invisible to the human eye**; models trained on them **misidentify the face 70% more often**

Other projects on GitHub

Skills

Design: Visual UI, Prototyping, Usability Testing, Computer Vision, Data Science, UX Research, Product Strategy, Digital Products, HCI, Figma, Photoshop, Adobe, Claude Code,
Languages: Python, HTML/CSS/Javascript, TypeScript, R, SQL, C++, Java, Bash, MATLAB